

Codebook for RQ2 - User Attitudes toward PSM Misratings

Category	Explanation	Quotes	Percentage
<i>Unreliable and Ineffective</i>	Participants criticized the usefulness and reliability of PSMs, stating that frequent misratings undermine their value.	"Most of them were wrong and not a good indicator of quality and actual strength."	35.98%
<i>Confusion and Frustration</i>	Participants expressed confusion and frustration due to inconsistent PSM ratings, which made it difficult to judge password strength.	"I think it is extremely frustrating! I wasn't able to discern a pattern and I honestly can't tell which passwords the strength meter would consider to be correct."	29.71%
<i>Still Beneficial Despite Misratings</i>	Participants acknowledged misratings but still found PSMs useful for general guidance.	"Even though there is some misalignment, I still believe it helps people create better passwords."	15.06%
<i>False Sense of Security</i>	Participants noted that misleading ratings could give users a false sense of password security, leading to unsafe practices.	"The misalignment between a PSM rating and the benchmark strength of a password can be a bit concerning because it can create a false sense of security for users."	13.39%
<i>Indifference and Self Reliance</i>	Participants indicated they ignored PSMs and preferred using personal judgment for password creation.	"I rarely look into the password meter and go by my own rules."	5.86%

Codebook for RQ2 - Perceived Causes of Misratings

Category	Explanation	Quotes	Percentage
<i>Algorithm Limitations</i>	Participants attributed misratings to oversimplified or outdated algorithmic rules used in PSMs.	"PSMs often prioritize simple metrics like length and character variety, neglecting the importance of avoiding common words and patterns..."	79.23%
<i>Divergent Definitions of Password Strength</i>	Participants believed that different websites have inconsistent standards for password strength, contributing to rating misalignments.	"I think this depends on how each website views password security. Some websites have a low awareness of password security and may use outdated PSM systems..."	16.39%
<i>Skepticism toward Benchmark Evaluations</i>	Participants questioned whether the benchmark classification of non-strong passwords was valid.	"I'd like to know how those claims were based because in my opinion, it's very unlikely that any of those passwords could be easily guessed."	4.37%

Codebook for RQ3 - Influence of Reduced Trust on Future Behavior

Category	Explanation	Quotes	Percentage
<i>Reduced Reliance on PSMs</i>	Participants intended to rely less on PSMs and instead use personal judgment or external tools like password managers.	"To keep track of complex passwords, I will consider using a reputable password manager."	79.86%
<i>No Behavioral Change</i>	Participants who already distrusted PSMs did not plan to change their behavior despite the misalignment.	"I try not to rely on PSMs for assurance, and instead I go above and beyond what is explicitly required."	10.25%
<i>Continued Reliance on PSMs</i>	Participants planned to continue using PSMs despite reduced trust, due to necessity or as a supplementary tool.	"I'm going to listen to them because I think in most cases you can't proceed until they consider it strong enough."	9.89%